

An action alert is a message that an organization sends to mobilize people, often members of the group and supporters of a specific point of view, calling on them to take action to influence public policy. Typically, action alerts are in reference to a timely issue, where prompt action is needed in order to affect upcoming decisions.

Description

Action alerts are considered a cost-effective and efficient grassroots organizing tool and are employed widely by many advocacy organizations. A well-designed action alert can be a "powerful way to invite people to participate in the processes of a democracy."

Action alerts may, for instance, ask supporters to:

Contact their legislator to highlight the issue or argue for/against proposed legislation; or

Write a letter to the editor about a specific item in the news.

Action alerts commonly begin by explaining the public policy issue to the recipients, and then tell the reader how they can impact the decision. Action alerts go by many other names. Amnesty International, for instance, refers to them as "Urgent actions".

Organisations that use action alerts

Citizens Against Government Waste

People for the Ethical Treatment of Animals

Electronic Frontier Foundation

Union of Concerned Scientists

American Family Association

Public Citizen

National Right to Work Committee

Tea Party Express

Free Software Foundation

Unrepresented Nations and Peoples Organization

Amnesty International

Human Rights Watch

Corruption Watch (South Africa)

Transparency International

Indonesia Corruption Watch

Anti-Corruption Foundation

Watchdog.org

International Republican Institute

== References ==